CARLOS BARAJAS

PLATFORM ENGINEERING & DEVOPS LEADER

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Platform engineering and DevOps leader with nearly two decades in production systems, setting strategy for internal developer platforms, GitOps, and cloud infrastructure across Azure and AWS. Owns the platform roadmap at Blue Shield of California (Stellarus), moving from team self-managed infrastructure to a centralized, GitOps-driven model, and leads a projected $4M modernization that gives 40+ teams Backstage-driven self-service while making FinOps an informed partner rather than a gate. Has built and led organizations of up to 24 engineers across the US, EU, India, and China, and ties platform investment to business outcomes: production promotion cut from 7 days to 15 minutes, uptime raised from 97% to 99% across 5 platforms, and ISO 27001 certification maintained through CI/CD and access guardrails.

EXPERIENCE

Blue Shield of California (Stellarus)

Sr. Manager, Technical Engineering (Platform Engineering)

Feb 2026 – Present

- Lead a 13-engineer Platform Engineering team (3 principal, 5 lead, 3 senior, 2 professional) supporting an internal development platform centered on cloud infrastructure automation, where software teams own their own infrastructure, built on Azure APIs with Ansible and Digital.ai.
- Spearhead the replacement of Digital.ai Release with a Backstage-driven self-service cloud provisioning platform, managing and providing technical direction to 8 remote engineers while balancing operational work; on track for completion by June 2027 with a projected $4M in value to the company:
  - Building Backstage software templates as the interface for Azure changes, replacing free-form inputs with catalog references to simplify provisioning for 40+ teams
  - Converting ~70 Ansible playbooks into ~30 modular OpenTofu modules covering resource groups, AKS, Azure SQL, Key Vault, VMs, App Service Plans, networking, and service principals, reducing configuration drift
  - Orchestrating changes through GitHub Actions, Atlantis, and Ansible Automation Platform
  - Partnering with FinOps to turn cost approval for net-new infrastructure from a blocking gate into informed oversight
- Set the product roadmap transforming the platform from team self-managed infrastructure to a centralized, GitOps-driven model:
  - Foundational infrastructure with OpenTofu & Terraform
  - Application infrastructure with Crossplane
  - Backstage as the internal developer portal
  - ArgoCD for delivery and Kargo for promotion
  - DORA metrics for measuring developer productivity
- Drive migration of teams from Bitbucket & Jenkins to GitHub and GitHub Actions, incorporating agentic solutions (GitHub Copilot, Codex, Claude Code).

Allergan Aesthetics (AbbVie)

Cloud Engineering Manager (Developer Experience & DevOps)

Jun 2024 – Feb 2026

- Led 14 engineers across two teams: DevOps (10 engineers: 1 staff, 9 senior) and Developer Experience (4 platform engineers: 1 principal, 1 staff, 1 lead, 1 senior), owning engineering infrastructure and developer productivity at scale.
- Drove implementation and deployment of an internal developer portal using Spotify's

SKILLS

Leadership
Team development · global/cross-functional team management · product roadmaps · mentorship · stakeholder partnership (FinOps, Product, Security)

Cloud
Azure · AWS

Internal Developer Platform
Backstage · software catalog · software templates

Infrastructure as Code & Config Management
Terraform · OpenTofu · Crossplane · Ansible · Ansible Automation Platform · SaltStack · Puppet · Kustomize

Containers
Docker · Docker Compose · Kubernetes (EKS, AKS) · Helm · Keda

CI/CD & GitOps
GitHub Actions · GitLab · Jenkins · Bitbucket Pipelines · TeamCity · Octopus Deploy · Digital.ai · ArgoCD · Kargo · Atlantis

Languages
Go · C# · Java · Python · Node.js/NestJS · Delphi · SQL

Messaging & Data
RabbitMQ · MySQL · Postgres · MSSQL · Elasticsearch/OpenSearch

Observability & Incident Response
Datadog · Dynatrace · Grafana · Prometheus · PagerDuty · DORA metrics

Security & Compliance
ISO 27001 · CI vulnerability scanning · CI/CD and infrastructure access guardrails

AI / Agentic Dev Tooling
GitHub Copilot · Codex · Claude Code

Collaboration
Jira · Confluence · Git

EDUCATION

Coleman University
B.S. Computer Information Systems, San Diego, CA

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Santa Barbara Tax Products Group
Lead Applications Developer / Programmer Analyst
Jun 2008 – Oct 2015
Built and enhanced C#/.NET and Delphi financial-products systems, ACH and

Backstage, cutting the time to promote a service to production from 7 days to 15 minutes and improving service discovery, documentation, and onboarding workflows.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to reduce friction in the development lifecycle through self-service tooling, automation, and improved onboarding.
- Set infrastructure direction for engineering teams designing, deploying, and managing workloads on AWS and Kubernetes, with an emphasis on scalability and reliability.
- Enabled a shift-left infrastructure model with internal tools that let teams provision and manage resources independently.
- Directed migration of ~70 legacy workloads to containerized services using Docker and Kubernetes.
- Established observability standards and operational tooling, moving teams toward software-driven operations.

Shell Recharge Solutions

Jun 2021 – Jun 2024 · EV charging OCPP/OCPI platform · ~15K charging stations across US & EU regions

Site Reliability Engineering Manager

Oct 2021 – Jun 2024

- Led two SRE teams in the US and India totaling 10 engineers (2 leads, 8 senior), coordinating across US, EU, and India time zones; improved uptime from 97% to 99% across 5 platforms.
- Served as interim Cybersecurity Engineering Manager, ensuring the company maintained its ISO 27001 certification: enforced compliance controls, implemented guardrails between CI/CD and infrastructure access controls, added security/vulnerability checks to the CI pipeline, and drove patching across EC2 instances, base Docker images, and Java/Go applications.
- Established end-to-end observability with Datadog using a code-first approach — Terraform-managed monitors, SLOs, and synthetic testing — and set logging standards for application development; the resulting metrics enabled proactive fixes and load scaling that cut incident frequency from roughly every 48 hours to once every two weeks.

Senior DevOps Engineer

Jun 2021 – Oct 2021

Green Dot Corp

Dec 2017 – Jun 2021

Site Reliability Engineering Manager

Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

- Led a 3-engineer SRE team (1 lead, 2 senior); introduced service-level objectives and error budgets, building a reliability-oriented mindset with the product team.
- Established a tier 3 support model, reducing product-development engagement and increasing backlog productivity.

Software Engineering Manager

Apr 2019 – Feb 2021

- Managed 24 engineers across multiple scrum teams in the US, India, and China (1 senior principal, 3 leads, and 20 senior and professional engineers), delivering business objectives on aggressive timelines.
- Migrated ~20 legacy Delphi and .NET Framework applications to .NET Core, deployed as Docker containers.

Senior Software Engineer

Dec 2017 – Apr 2019

Lightstream

Software Engineer

Oct 2015 – Dec 2017

- Founding member of the company's first DevOps team; owned upgrades and administration of TeamCity and Octopus Deploy.

XML file-processing services, and co-designed the company MSSQL database.

Coleman University

Part-time Instructor, Java & JavaScript

Aug 2011 – Oct 2012

Taught object-oriented programming in Java and introductory JavaScript/web development.

INTERESTS

Martial arts (BJJ, Tai Chi, Kung Fu)

Hobby development exploring new languages and technologies

Video gaming (puzzle, strategy, base building)